

Philipp Hilbert. *Product owner who ships, not just manages.*

Positioning, 13 years of end-to-end product ownership in regulated industries, insurance, healthcare, payments, now applied to a single-product build mandate in Dubai.

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I am writing about the Senior Product Owner role at Discovered MENA. I have spent 13 years owning products end to end in regulated industries, insurance, healthcare, payments, and defence AI, and the shape of this role maps closely to how I actually work: one product, one owner, full responsibility from first idea to live release.

The insurance domain is not adjacent knowledge for me; it is direct experience. At EMIL Group I joined an 18-person delivery organisation that was losing its senior engineers and its client trust simultaneously. I restructured it into three lean teams with their own leads, and then shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no internal precedent, reducing time-to-market for a new insurance product from many months to under a week. Before that, I spent more than a year as Proxy Product Owner at AOK ITSCare, migrating a procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurance entities and around 20,000 employees, a system still in production today. I understand how insurers buy technology, how compliance shapes the backlog, and why stakeholder alignment in that sector takes longer and matters more than in consumer software.

On the delivery side, I run Agile without making it a ceremony production. At Rohde & Schwarz I introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD across a multinational team: rollout time fell from days to 30 minutes and the platform became hotfix-capable. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline and carried a full UI relaunch through a parallel containerisation programme, while also serving as Deputy IT Security Officer. These are not things I delegated; I owned the technical depth and the stakeholder communication at the same time.

On AI, my engagement is hands-on rather than theoretical. I prototype with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Cursor, use LLM agents to generate acceptance criteria and edge-case catalogues, and have built agentic workflows including a multi-agent coding framework I developed independently. I understand where AI speeds up product delivery and where it introduces governance risk, relevant in any financial services environment operating under evolving regulatory expectations.

Dubai is not a compromise location for me. I am actively targeting the UAE and am ready to relocate and work fully on-site or hybrid from day one.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
